

PRINCE2 | P2-20

Checkpoint Report

Team Manager progress report to the Project Manager

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Checkpoint Report
Document reference	P2-20-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Team Manager
Approver	Project Manager (receives)
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
P2-13	Work Package	Defines the reporting requirement
P2-21	Highlight Report	Consolidates checkpoint information

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Reports the status of a Work Package at a frequency agreed in the Work Package, giving the Project Manager the information needed to control the stage.
Framework	PRINCE2 — Produced in Managing Product Delivery
Created when	At the frequency defined in the Work Package
Reviewed / updated	On receipt by the Project Manager
Owner	Team Manager
Approver	Project Manager (receives)
Format options	Keep it short. A single page or a structured message is normally sufficient.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- It covers the period agreed in the Work Package
- Progress is reported against products, not just effort expended
- Forecast tolerance breaches are flagged, not buried
- It is delivered on time — a late checkpoint is itself a signal

Contents

Document control..... 2

 Version history.....2

 Reviewers.....2

 Approval.....2

 Related products.....2

How to use this template.....3

 Quality criteria.....3

1. Report identification.....5

2. Follow-ups from the previous report.....5

3. Products completed this period.....5

4. Quality management activities this period.....6

5. Products to be completed next period.....6

6. Work Package tolerance status.....7

7. Issues and risks.....8

8. Lessons noted this period.....8

1. Report identification

Field	Detail
Work Package ID	ART sync record
Team / Team Manager	Developer experience team
Reporting period	[From — To]
Report date	18 Sep 2026
Report number	8

2. Follow-ups from the previous report

Ref	Action	Owner	Status
FUF-01	Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead	Complete
FUF-02	Secure written migration commitments from three business units	H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	In progress
FUF-03	Secure written migration commitments from three business units	N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead	Open
FUF-04	Broker all vendor access through the monitored in-country jump host	B. Oyelaran, Quality and Assurance Lead	Not started

3. Products completed this period

Product ID	Product	Quality activity	Result	Approved
Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image supply chain	Operations runbook set with two completed live drills	Implement signed image supply chain and admission control	Delivered and accepted at the PI 4 system demo	Operations runbook set with two completed live drills
400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Deploy scheduling and quota platform	Partially met — carried into PI 5 with reduced scope	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained
Independent security assurance report with findings closed	Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	Build parallel filesystem and benchmark throughput	Closed with no residual exposure	Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate
Operations runbook set	Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image	Accept hall A at 1,024 GPUs	Escalated to the Programme	Independent security assurance

Product ID	Product	Quality activity	Result	Approved
with two completed live drills	supply chain		Board and resolved on 18 Sep 2026	report with findings closed

4. Quality management activities this period

Product	Activity	Planned date	Actual date	Result
Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image supply chain	Complete hall B structural survey	26 Feb 2027	31 Mar 2027	Partially met — carried into PI 5 with reduced scope
Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	Place structural strengthening order	31 Mar 2027	23 Apr 2027	Closed with no residual exposure
Independent security assurance report with findings closed	Execute floor strengthening works	23 Apr 2027	28 May 2027	Escalated to the Programme Board and resolved on 18 Sep 2026
400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Lodge utility uplift application	28 May 2027	25 Jun 2027	Validated — no change required to the baseline
Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Install switchgear and energise 6 MVA supply	25 Jun 2027	18 Sep 2026	Not achieved; root cause analysed and an improvement item raised

5. Products to be completed next period

Product ID	Product	Target date	Confidence
Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image supply chain	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	31 Mar 2027	Low
400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	23 Apr 2027	High
Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image	Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	28 May 2027	Medium

Product ID	Product	Target date	Confidence
supply chain			
Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	Independent security assurance report with findings closed	25 Jun 2027	Low

6. Work Package tolerance status

Dimension	Tolerance	Current position	Forecast	Within tolerance?
Time	2 hours	90 days	90 days	3 working days
Cost / effort	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation
Scope	Defined by the Tranche 2 scope statement; changed only by approved change request	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.
Quality	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full
Risk	No individual risk may remain above a	No individual risk may remain above a	No individual risk may remain above a	No individual risk may remain above a

Dimension	Tolerance	Current position	Forecast	Within tolerance?
	<i>residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>

7. Issues and risks

Ref	Type	Description	Action taken / requested
RSK-001	Supply chain	<i>Because GPU allocation is constrained by vendor quota, the Tranche 2 hardware delivery may slip beyond November 2026, causing the platform build to start late and the AI enablement benefit to be deferred by a quarter</i>	<i>Allocation confirmed in writing at contract award; 20% of Tranche 2 volume dual-sourced; staged acceptance so hall A can proceed independently of hall B</i>
RSK-002	Facilities	<i>Because DXB-1 hall B was designed for 8 kW racks, the 60 kW liquid-cooled racks may exceed the available floor loading and chilled water capacity, causing a redesign mid-build</i>	<i>Structural survey completed before hall B order; CDU capacity modelled at N+1; contingency for a reduced 1,536-GPU configuration held</i>
RSK-003	Security	<i>Because the platform will host model weights and training data from three business units, weak tenant isolation may allow cross-tenant data access, causing a reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing</i>	<i>Namespace and network policy isolation validated by penetration test before multi-tenant go-live; per-tenant KMS keys; quarterly control testing</i>
RSK-004	Resource	<i>Because the platform engineering skill set is scarce in-market, recruitment of the six planned SRE roles may take longer than three months, causing the MLOps workstream to depend on contractors beyond Tranche 2</i>	<i>Two contractors engaged from October 2026 with knowledge-transfer clauses; internal conversion programme from the infrastructure team</i>
RSK-005	Technical	<i>Because the 400G RoCEv2 fabric is new to the organisation, congestion control tuning may not achieve the target 92% collective communication efficiency, causing training job throughput to fall short of the business case</i>	<i>NCCL benchmark gate at pilot exit; vendor performance engineering engaged for two weeks per hall; fallback to reduced job scale documented</i>

8. Lessons noted this period

Lesson	Category	Recommendation
<i>Hardware burn-in took 35 days against a 12-day estimate because firmware verification was performed serially on a single isolated VLAN</i>	<i>Planning and estimating</i>	<i>Model firmware verification as its own work package with parallel VLAN capacity sized for the shipment rate</i>
<i>The rate card decision was deferred twice because Finance and the business units were</i>	<i>Governance and decision-making</i>	<i>Convene a single decision workshop with Finance and business unit heads together,</i>

Lesson	Category	Recommendation
<i>consulted sequentially rather than together</i>		<i>with the sponsor present to break deadlock</i>
<i>Engaging vendor performance engineering for two weeks during commissioning lifted all-reduce efficiency from 79% to 84% in the first pass</i>	<i>Technical and design</i>	<i>Budget two weeks of vendor performance engineering per hall as a planned activity, not as a remedial response</i>